

# Day 111 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

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## Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in Indian Polity (10): Cabinet Approvals — NCR Vehicle Replacement & Airline Fuel Stabilization

### READING MATERIAL

*Covers 2 Union Cabinet approvals from 3 June 2026 — a vehicle-replacement scheme for Delhi-NCR and an airline fuel price-stabilization fund.*

**Q:** What scheme did the Union Cabinet approve on 3 June 2026 for the Delhi-NCR region, and what is its purpose?

**A:** A 2-year scheme for support to NCRPB (National Capital Region Planning Board) for replacement of old trucks and buses — aimed at reducing air pollution and promoting cleaner mobility in Delhi-NCR.

**Q:** Which Ministries are involved in implementing this NCR vehicle-replacement scheme?

**A:** Funded through NCRPB under the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs; implemented by the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways and the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas.

**Q:** What does the NCR vehicle-replacement scheme incentivize vehicle owners to do?

**A:** To replace trucks/buses (registered in Delhi-NCR) that comply only with BS-IV or earlier emission norms, with BS-VI or stricter emission-compliant vehicles, or electric vehicles (EVs).

**Q:** What other scheme did the Cabinet approve on the same day (3 June 2026), related to aviation?

**A:** A Price Stabilization Fund for Scheduled Indian Airlines, towards ATF (Aviation Turbine Fuel) pricing.

### MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The Union Cabinet approved a scheme for support to NCRPB for vehicle replacement on:

- A. 3 May 2026
- B. 3 June 2026 ✓**
- C. 3 July 2026
- D. 3 August 2026

*Explanation:* 3 June 2026. [medium, web-research]

2. NCRPB stands for, and operates under which Ministry?

- A. National Capital Region Planning Board, under Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs ✓**
- B. National Climate Research Planning Bureau, under Ministry of Environment
- C. National Crop Research Promotion Board, under Ministry of Agriculture
- D. National Civil Registration Process Bureau, under Ministry of Home Affairs

*Explanation:* National Capital Region Planning Board, under Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs. [hard, web-research]

3. The NCR vehicle-replacement scheme targets trucks/buses complying only with which emission norms?

- A. BS-VI or stricter
- B. BS-V
- C. BS-IV or earlier ✓**
- D. Euro-VI

*Explanation:* BS-IV or earlier. [medium, web-research]

4. The Price Stabilization Fund approved on 3 June 2026 (same Cabinet meeting) addresses pricing of:

- A. LPG for households
- B. ATF (Aviation Turbine Fuel) for airlines ✓**
- C. Diesel for trucks
- D. CNG for buses

*Explanation:* ATF (Aviation Turbine Fuel) for scheduled Indian airlines. [medium, web-research]

## Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Alphanumeric Reasoning

### READING MATERIAL

*Alphanumeric Reasoning is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills, combining letters and numbers in a single pattern. Real exam evidence (independently re-verified) shows three core techniques: letter-to-number position coding, variable-gap letter sequences, and fixed-shift word ciphers.*

**Q:** Method — letter-to-number position coding: If ACEG is coded as 16, and DFGH is coded as 25, how would HIKM be coded?

**A:** Each letter is converted to its position in the alphabet (A=1, B=2, ... Z=26) and summed. ACEG: A=1, C=3, E=5, G=7, sum=16 ✓. DFGH: D=4, F=6, G=7, H=8, sum=25 ✓. Applying the same rule to HIKM: H=8, I=9, K=11, M=13, sum=8+9+11+13=41.

**Q:** Method — widening-gap letter sequence: Find the next letter: B, E, I, N, ?

**A:** Check the gaps between consecutive letters' positions: B(2)→E(5) is +3, E(5)→I(9) is +4, I(9)→N(14) is +5. The gap itself increases by 1 each time, so the next gap is +6: N(14)+6=20, which is T.

**Q:** Method — fixed-shift word coding (Caesar-cipher style): If ROAD is coded as URDG, how would SWAN be coded using the same rule?

**A:** Check the shift for each letter: R→U is +3, O→R is +3, A→D is +3, D→G is +3 — a uniform +3 shift applied to every letter. Applying the same +3 shift to SWAN: S→V, W→Z, A→D, N→Q, giving VZDQ.

**Q:** Method — two-interleaved-sequences letter pair: A pattern alternates first-letters increasing by a fixed gap and second-letters decreasing by the same gap (e.g., AZ, GT, MN, ?, YB). How do you solve it?

**A:** Track the two positions (first letter, second letter) as SEPARATE sequences. First letters: A(1), G(7), M(13) — increasing by 6 each time, so next is 19=S, then 25=Y (matches the given final term Y). Second letters: Z(26), T(20), N(14) — decreasing by 6 each time, so next is 8=H, then 2=B (matches the given final term B). So the missing term is S+H = 'SH'.

### MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. If BDFH is coded as 20 (sum of letter positions), what would CEGI be coded as using the same rule?

- A. 22
- B. 24 ✓**
- C. 26
- D. 28

*Explanation:* C=3, E=5, G=7, I=9, sum=24. (Check rule: B=2, D=4, F=6, H=8, sum=20 ✓ matches given.) [medium, authored]

2. Find the next letter in the sequence: C, F, J, O, ?

- A. S
- B. T
- C. U ✓**
- D. V

*Explanation:* Gaps: C(3)→F(6) is +3, F(6)→J(10) is +4, J(10)→O(15) is +5, so next gap is +6: O(15)+6=21=U. [medium, authored]

3. If PLAN is coded as SODQ using a fixed letter shift, how would TRIM be coded using the same rule?

- A. WULP ✓**
- B. WUKP
- C. VULP
- D. WULO

*Explanation:* Shift check: P→S, L→O, A→D, N→Q — a uniform +3 shift. Applying +3 to TRIM: T→W, R→U, I→L, M→P, giving WULP. [hard, authored]

4. In the sequence DY, IT, NO, ?, XE, the first letters increase and second letters decrease by a fixed gap. What is the missing term?

- A. SJ ✓**
- B. SI
- C. TJ
- D. RJ

*Explanation:* First letters: D(4), I(9), N(14) — gap +5, so next is 19=S, then 24=X (matches given X). Second letters: Y(25), T(20), O(15) — gap -5, so next is 10=J, then 5=E (matches given E). Missing term: SJ. [hard, authored]

## Part C – General English: Poem: "The House on Elm Street" — Naida Bush

### READING MATERIAL

*A poem describing an isolated, eerie, possibly haunted house, told through a narrator who feels both curiosity and fear. Real coaching-site evidence focuses on (a) the house's physical description and atmosphere, (b) the narrator's emotional reaction, and (c) figures of speech describing the house as if alive.*

**Q:** Who wrote "The House on Elm Street", and what is the poem's central theme?

**A:** Naida Bush (spelled 'Nadia Bush' on some coaching sites — syllabus spelling 'Naida Bush' is authoritative). Central theme: a mysterious, isolated house that feels eerie and almost alive, exploring how the unknown provokes a mix of curiosity and fear in an observer.

**Q:** How is the house's isolation and emptiness described?

**A:** "It sat alone" — describing the house as lonely and isolated, set apart from other buildings. "Bare to the bone" describes it as completely empty or lifeless, stripped of any warmth or occupants.

**Q:** What dominant emotion does the poet/narrator express toward the house?

**A:** Curiosity mixed with fear — the narrator is drawn to investigate the mysterious house but is simultaneously afraid, and per the poem, fear ultimately overtakes curiosity (the narrator does not enter).

**Q:** What unnatural/spooky details does the poem use to bring the house 'to life'?

**A:** Lights that flicker on and off (suggesting something unnatural rather than a simple power outage); the house seeming 'a bit brighter' in summer (around May); and a tree beside the house that strangely never grows or sheds its leaves — all small unnatural details that build an eerie atmosphere.

**Q:** What does the line "It plays with your mind" suggest?

**A:** Psychological/mental unease and confusion — the house's effect is described as primarily a mental or emotional disturbance rather than a physical threat.

**Q:** Identify the figure of speech: "At night the house seems to be alive."

**A:** Personification — attributing life/animation to the inanimate house.

**Q:** Identify the figure of speech: "The house seems to be a bit brighter" (in the context of describing the house's mood/behaviour changing with the season).

**A:** Personification — again attributing a living, changeable quality (mood/appearance shifting like a living thing) to the house.

### MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "The House on Elm Street" was written by:

A. Jane Taylor

**B. Naida Bush ✓**

C. L.M. Montgomery

D. Emily Dickinson

*Explanation:* Naida Bush (per the TNPSC syllabus spelling; some sources spell it 'Nadia Bush'). [easy, web-research]

2. The central theme of the poem is:

A. A peaceful village

**B. A mysterious, possibly haunted house ✓**

C. A family gathering

D. A natural disaster

*Explanation:* A mysterious haunted house. [easy, web-research]

3. What dominant emotion does the narrator express toward the house?

A. Anger

B. Joy

**C. Curiosity mixed with fear ✓**

D. Boredom

*Explanation:* Curiosity mixed with fear. [medium, web-research]

4. "It sat alone" implies that the house is:

A. In a busy town

**B. Lonely and isolated ✓**

C. Overcrowded

D. A guest house

*Explanation:* Lonely and isolated. [easy, web-research]

5. The phrase "bare to the bone" (describing the house) means:

A. Full of bones

B. Very strong

**C. Completely empty or lifeless ✓**

D. Covered in skin

*Explanation:* Completely empty or lifeless. [medium, web-research]

6. Why does the narrator ultimately not enter the house?

A. There are dogs inside

B. It is guarded by someone

**C. Fear overtakes curiosity ✓**

D. She has no time

*Explanation:* Fear overtakes curiosity. [medium, web-research]

7. "Lights flicker on and off" in the poem creates an image of:

A. A simple power outage

B. Normal home life

**C. Something unnatural and spooky ✓**

D. Traffic signals

*Explanation:* Something unnatural and spooky. [medium, web-research]

8. What is strange about the tree beside the house?

A. It has golden leaves

B. It grows sideways

**C. It never grows or sheds its leaves ✓**

D. It talks to the house

*Explanation:* It never grows or sheds its leaves. [medium, web-research]

9. "It plays with your mind" refers to:

A. Physical tricks

**B. Confusion and mental unease ✓**

C. Educational games

D. Hallucination caused by drugs

*Explanation:* Confusion and mental unease. [medium, web-research]

10. "At night the house seems to be alive" is an example of which figure of speech?

A. Simile

B. Irony

**C. Personification ✓**

D. Alliteration

*Explanation:* Personification. [medium, web-research]